

VOSS shoes – VAANSKO(which means ‘water shoes’ in Norwegian)

VOSS®

Brand identity and design inspiration-

VOSS is a Norwegian-headquartered premium water brand that has become a global symbol of modern elegance and minimalist luxury. Founded in 1998 by Ole Christian Sandberg and Christopher Harlem, the brand successfully transformed a basic commodity such as water into a high-end lifestyle accessory.

VOSS positions itself at the intersection of purity, distinction, and responsibility, offering a crisp, low-mineral water sourced from a protected artesian aquifer in Southern Norway that has become a staple in fine-dining environments. Its brand identity is anchored in Scandinavian minimalism, utilizing a signature "no-distractions" transparent design and sans-serif typography to emphasize the water's clarity. This aesthetic of luxury is balanced by a deep-rooted commitment to sustainability going from pioneering premium glass packaging and 100% recycled materials to the philanthropic efforts of the Voss Foundation, ensuring their elite image is backed by a core mission of environmental and social impact.

I decided to design shoes for the VOSS brand as I was deeply inspired by the brand itself and really like their design language. A sleek minimalist product that is complemented by the nature of the product. Clean lines, no colours, and a premium form is the perfect combination for an effective premium shoe brand for the future.



Fig 1.1- VOSS water bottle

Material study-

To align with the VOSS brand identity, the shoes should be constructed from materials that embody transparency, Scandinavian purity, and eco-conscious luxury. The primary upper would likely utilize a high-grade, transparent recycled TPU or a "liquid-effect" biopolymer, mirroring the iconic clarity of their glass bottles and the "Liquid Glass" aesthetic.

To ground this in sustainability, the structural elements would feature recycled ocean plastics or anodized aluminium eyelets, paying homage to their recyclable packaging. The aesthetic would be completed with a fluid and seamless form, a single piece that could be 3d printed to match recent production methods and to maintain the "no-distractions" minimalist silhouette that defines the brand's premium positioning.

Soft-Touch Polymers (Controlled Tactility) Materials-

- TPU (Thermoplastic Polyurethane)

- TPE

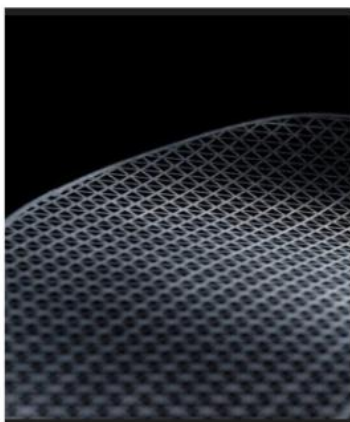
- Silicone elastomers.

Why They Work-

Slight compliance mimics skin-to-skin contact

Reduce startle reflex compared to hard plastics

High grip without sharp friction



recycled TPU



TPE



Silicon Elastomers

Mood-boards and inspirations-



Fig 1.2 – Mood-board



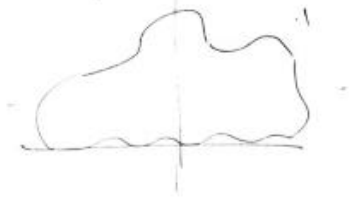
Fig 1.3 – VOSS promo images

Ideation and iterative sketches-

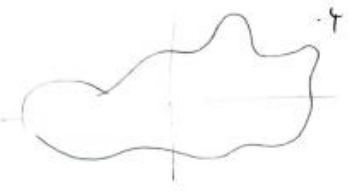
Focusing on fluid forms and a minimal single piece aesthetic in mind. The iterative sketches are all made to emphasize the freedom and fluidity of water. Each with varying proportion and features and forms.

I picked to do the sketches via pen and paper as it allows for most creativity and allows me to create ideations quickly and exactly what I have in mind.

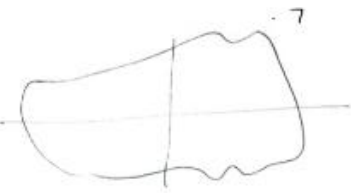
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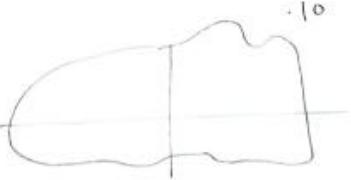
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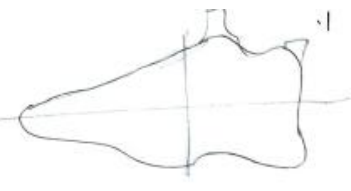
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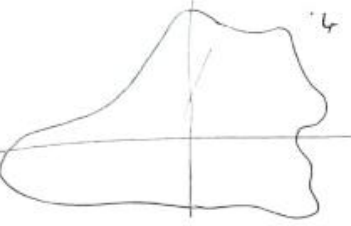
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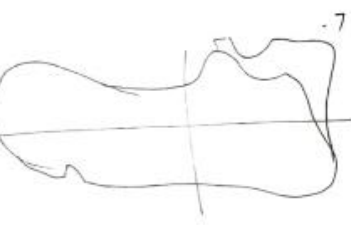
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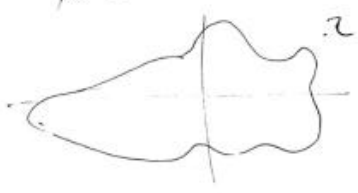
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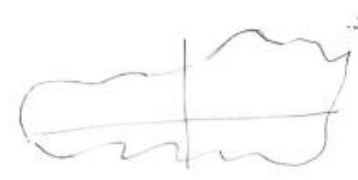
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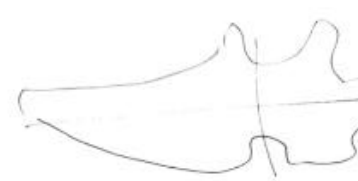
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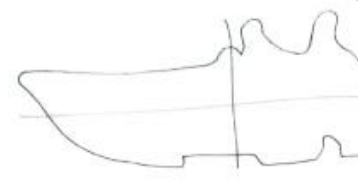
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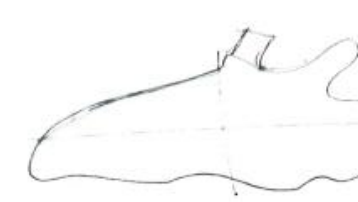
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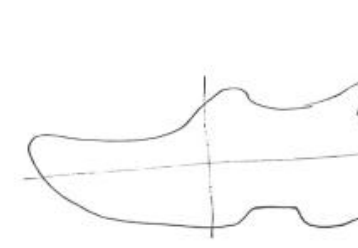
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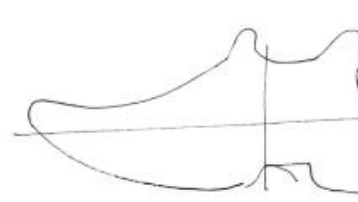
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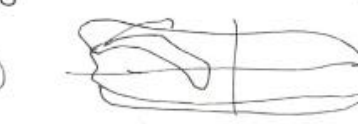
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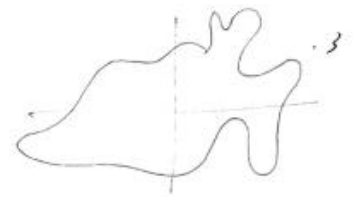


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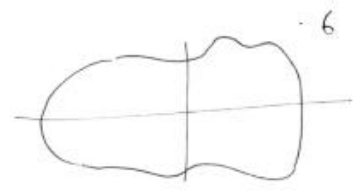


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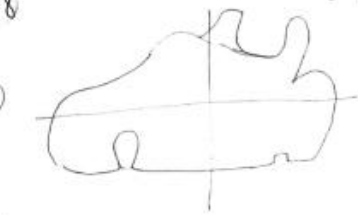
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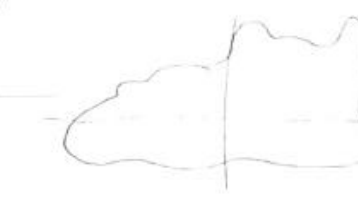
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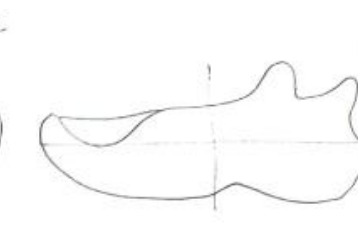
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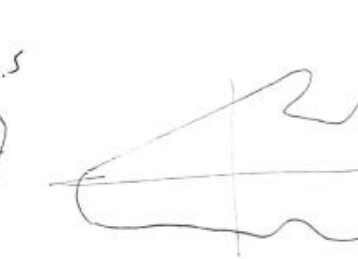
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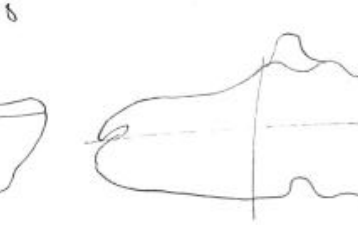
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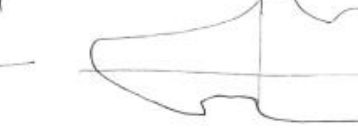
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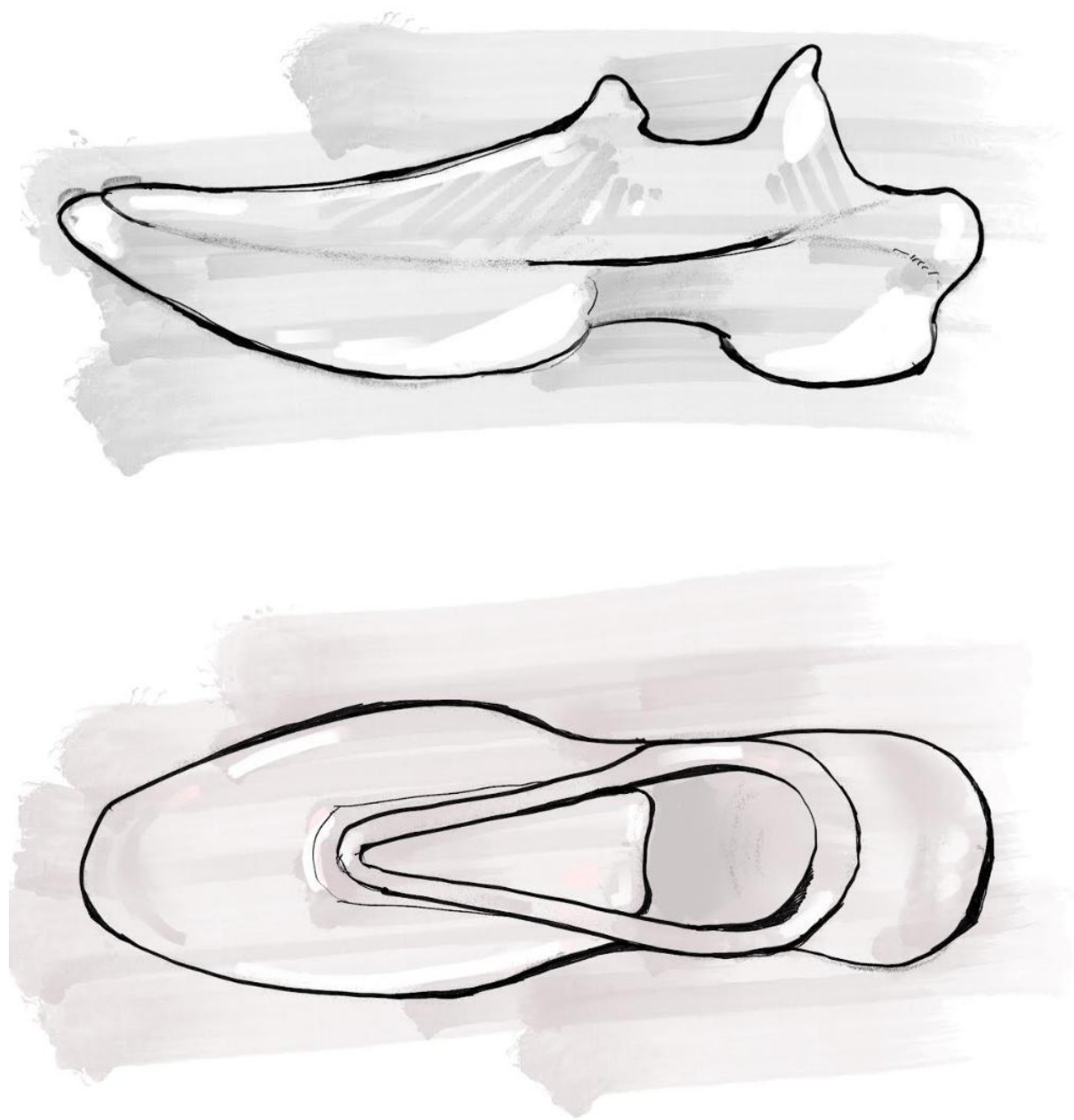


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Prototyping and finalizing form-

The final form I chose from my several iterations needed to strike a balance between elegance and minimalism. It was important that the design reflected a sense of fluidity, inspired by water, while also conveying the premium feel associated with the VOSS brand. At the same time, the form could not appear too bulky or casual, as that would conflict with the brand's refined aesthetic.

Keeping all these considerations in mind throughout the iteration process ultimately led me to the final form presented below.



3d modeling and mockups-



-- Original Glass variant --



-- Limited Black variant --



‘VAANSKO’ – ‘water shoes’ in Norwegian



--A dark Ad type mockup located in the Ikey landscape of Norway during night--



VOSS VAANSKO limited black edition advertisement



VOSS VAANSKO promo advertisement



Ad campaign to show transparency in production methods and environmental concern.



VAANSKO shoes in the glacier setting to show the source of the water